1 Ubuntu on the computer

QUICK

01. Turn the old Windows 7 laptop into an Ubuntu computer (from a USB stick)

Quick version

No time to read it all? This is the short version. The full guide is below.

- This is the one thing the garden does not do for you: putting Ubuntu on the computer. About 2 to 3 hours, free.
- Copy your files off the laptop first: **this erases Windows**.
- On a Windows computer, download Ubuntu 24.04 LTS (`.iso`) and **Rufus** (rufus.ie). Rufus puts Ubuntu on a 16 GB or larger USB stick (Part B).
- Start the laptop from the stick (tap the boot key, Part C), choose **Erase disk and install Ubuntu**.
- Choose a **user name** (for example `jun`), a **computer name** (for example `garden-lab`) and a **password**. Write them down. That password is also the one Ubuntu asks for when you change something (`sudo`): there is no separate "root password".
- Write down the laptop's **IP address** (Settings, Wi-Fi, the gear next to your network).
- Prefer not to change a laptop? A **Raspberry Pi 5** kit works too (guide 06).